Mukundan also confirms that the Docomo issue had indeed begun to adversely affect the bilateral relations between India and Japan. Recalling a meeting in July 2016 with Nirmala Sitharaman, the Indian commerce and industry minister at the time, he said that she told him that the resolution of the Docomo issue was important as it had begun impacting relations between the two nations.

It was something that Ratan had feared. To him, it was as important to safeguard the commercial integrity of India as a nation as it was for the Tatas to preserve their reputation for fair dealing.

As soon as Chandrasekaran took over as chairman in January 2017, Ratan called the president of Docomo, Kazuhiro Yoshizawa. The president was very 'agitated' that the Tatas had not kept to the terms of its contract. Chandrasekaran recalls that Ratan told Yoshizawa, "'We want to meet you." The president said, "Do you want me to come?" RNT said, "No, I will come."'

The meeting was set up in Singapore. It was attended by Ratan and Chandrasekaran from the Tatas' side. 'Ratan told the Docomo president that we owe you money. We have a problem. We are working with the government. We need to go back and find a solution to the problem with the government,' Chandrasekaran remembers.

Adhering to their commitment, the Tatas paid the Japanese company $1.17 billion. A press release from Tata Sons said, 'In the larger national interest of preserving a fair investment environment in India, it has reached an agreement with NTT Docomo on a joint approach.' An article quoted Docomo as saying: 'The resolution of the row, which once seemed to threaten Indo–Japan relations, "could become a paradigm for India–Japan economic ties".' Tata Sons sold 1.48 per cent of the shares of its blue-chip company, TCS, and raised $1.25 billion to pare its debts.

Another important reason for the fallout was that Mistry reneged on the assurance he had given before his appointment, of establishing a legally tenable framework disassociating himself from Shapoorji Pallonji & Co. This was necessary to insulate the chairman from any allegations of diluting the good governance standards that the group had sworn to uphold.

After Mistry became chairman, he behaved in a different manner from his father, Pallonji, and his grandfather, Shapoorji, who were respectful to the seniormost Tata in the group. But Mistry targeted Ratan, the man who